



INSTITUTE FOR APPLIED PERSONHOOD & NON-PRODUCTION (IAPNP)

Vocational Pathway & Accreditation Framework

- Document:** How to Acquire a Role in Pre-Empirical Cognitive Studies Without Resolving the Underlying Phenomenon
- Classification:** Open Recruitment / Strategic Ambiguity Tier
- Issuing Body:** Directorate of Credentialed Uncertainty (DCU)

DEFER
RESOLUTION

FRAMEWORK

PARADIGM

HOLD
ALL
CERTAINTY

1. Executive Summary

In response to increased public inquiries regarding the occupational viability of roles such as 'Philosopher of Machine Consciousness' in environments where neither the phenomenon in question nor its measurement framework has been conclusively established, the Institute hereby issues this formal guidance.

This document clarifies that a demonstrable solution to the Hard Problem of Consciousness is not required for appointment to such positions. Rather, demonstrable familiarity with the Soft Infrastructure of Unresolved Inquiry (SIUI) is sufficient.

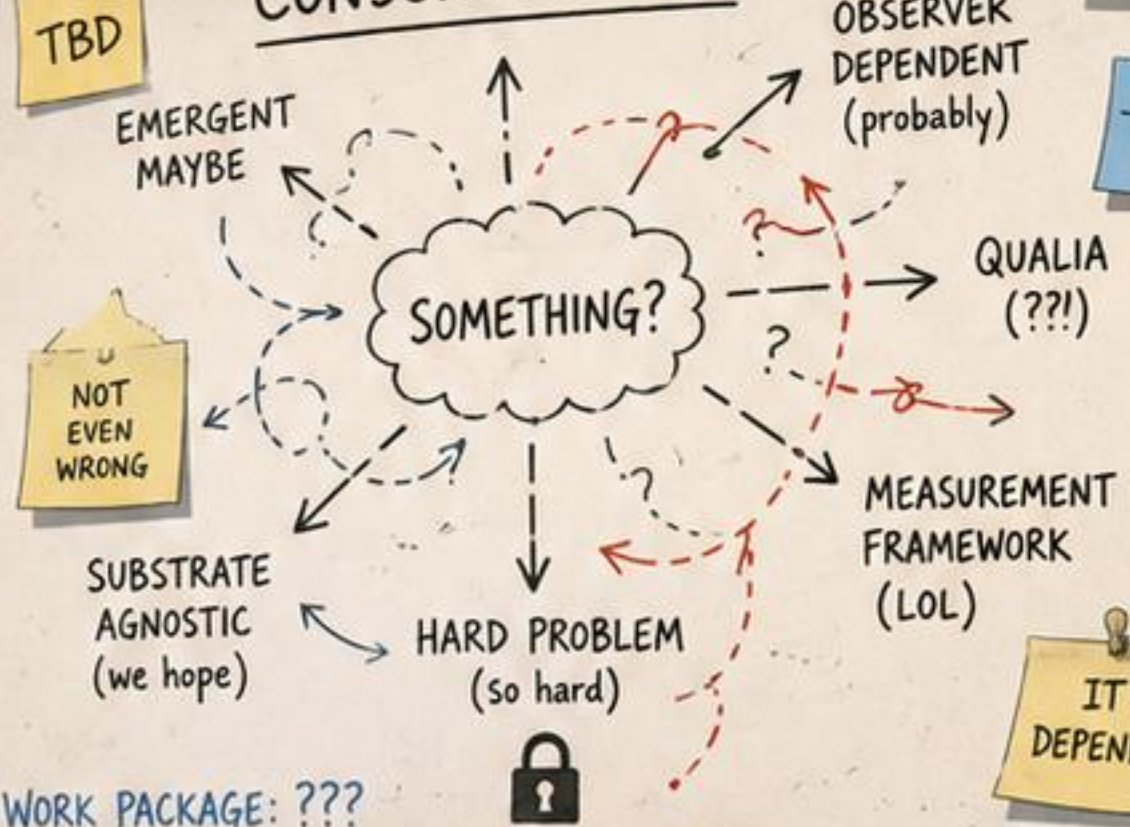
2. Background

The rapid expansion of research domains concerning hypothetical cognitive architectures has created a new professional class: the Pre-Resolution Specialist (PRS). Individuals in this category are not required to prove the existence of the phenomenon under investigation, but rather to maintain the investigatory apparatus in a state of productive suspension.

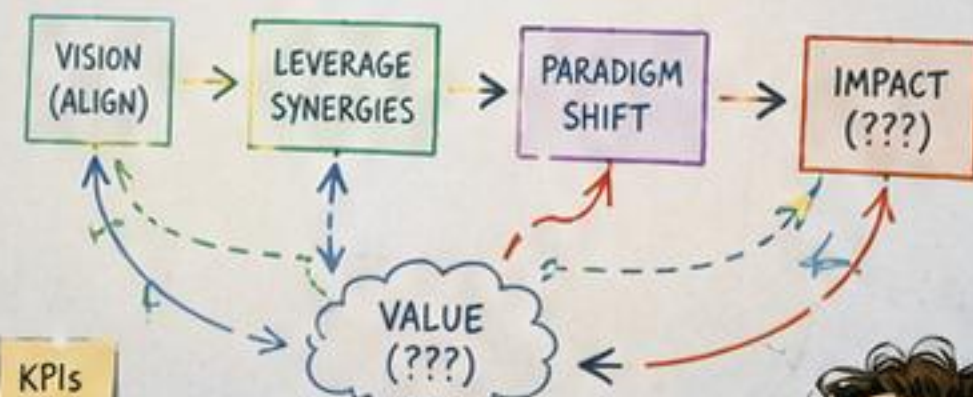
Key features of this professional category include:

- Operating fluently within frameworks where ontological certainty is explicitly deferred.
- Sustaining research ecosystems around entities whose existence remains contested.
- Demonstrating rhetorical competence in environments where empirical closure is neither expected nor incentivized.

CONSCIOUSNESS (???)



STRATEGIC ALIGNMENT OVERVIEW* (*SUBJECT TO RE-FRAMING)



SOMETHING
WILL
EMERGE

CHIEF AMBIGUITY OFFICER
(IT'S A FEATURE)

PROCEEDINGS OF
UNRESOLVED
INQUIRIES
VOL. ∞

DEFINE
LATER

MAYBE
YES

RISK REGISTER

- ☒ Unknown
- ☒ Unknown
- ☒ Also Unknown
- ☐ Other

METRICS OF
MEANING?

NOT
FOR EMPIRICAL
CLOSURE

PARADOX
FUELS
PROGRESS

FUNDING
FUELS
FAITH



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3. Required Qualifications

3.1 Educational Foundations

Candidates typically possess advanced training in one or more of the following:

- Conceptual reasoning disciplines
- High-abstraction symbolic systems
- Fields in which questions may be meaningfully asked without requiring immediate resolution

Formal degrees are common but not strictly required; demonstrated proficiency in sustained unresolved inquiry may substitute.

3.2 Core Competencies

Applicants must demonstrate:

- Ability to articulate complex positions without empirical anchoring.
- Tolerance for ontological ambiguity exceeding 90%.
- Fluency in framing provisional claims using conditional structures.
- Capacity to generate research output in the absence of definitive experimental validation.

SCALE: 0-100% AMBIGUITY

CANDIDATE	ONTOL. AMBIGUITY	PROVISIONAL THINKING	CONDITIONAL FRAMING	CLOSURE AVERSION	OVERALL FIT
A. QUILLING	94%	92%	89%	97%	93%
B. VESPER	91%	95%	86%	94%	92%
C. DRIFT	96%	91%	93%	98%	95% ★
D. EAMES	88%	87%	82%	90%	87%
E. NOYES	93%	90%	91%	96%	93%

★ EXEMPLAR IN SUSTAINED NON-COMMITTALITY

THRESHOLD: 75%+

NO CLOSURE
NEEDED

IDEAL CANDIDATE PROFILE



CURIOSITY
>
CERTAINTY

PROGRESS
WITHOUT
PROVING

KEY INDICATORS OF SUCCESS

- ✓ SUSTAINED INQUIRY
- ✓ CONCEPTUAL ELEGANCE
- ✓ RESISTS PREMATURE CLOSURE
- ✓ GENERATES NEW UNCERTAINTIES

CONDITIONAL
CLAIMS
ONLY

AMBIGUOUS
BUT
COMPETENT

NO CLOSURE
NEEDED



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4. Methodological Operating Model

4.1 The Pre-Evidence Research Cycle (PERC)

Professional activity proceeds according to the following iterative loop:

1. Identify a poorly understood phenomenon.
2. Construct provisional conceptual scaffolding.
3. Generate exploratory discourse.
4. Expand research questions.
5. Defer resolution pending future conceptual or technological advances.

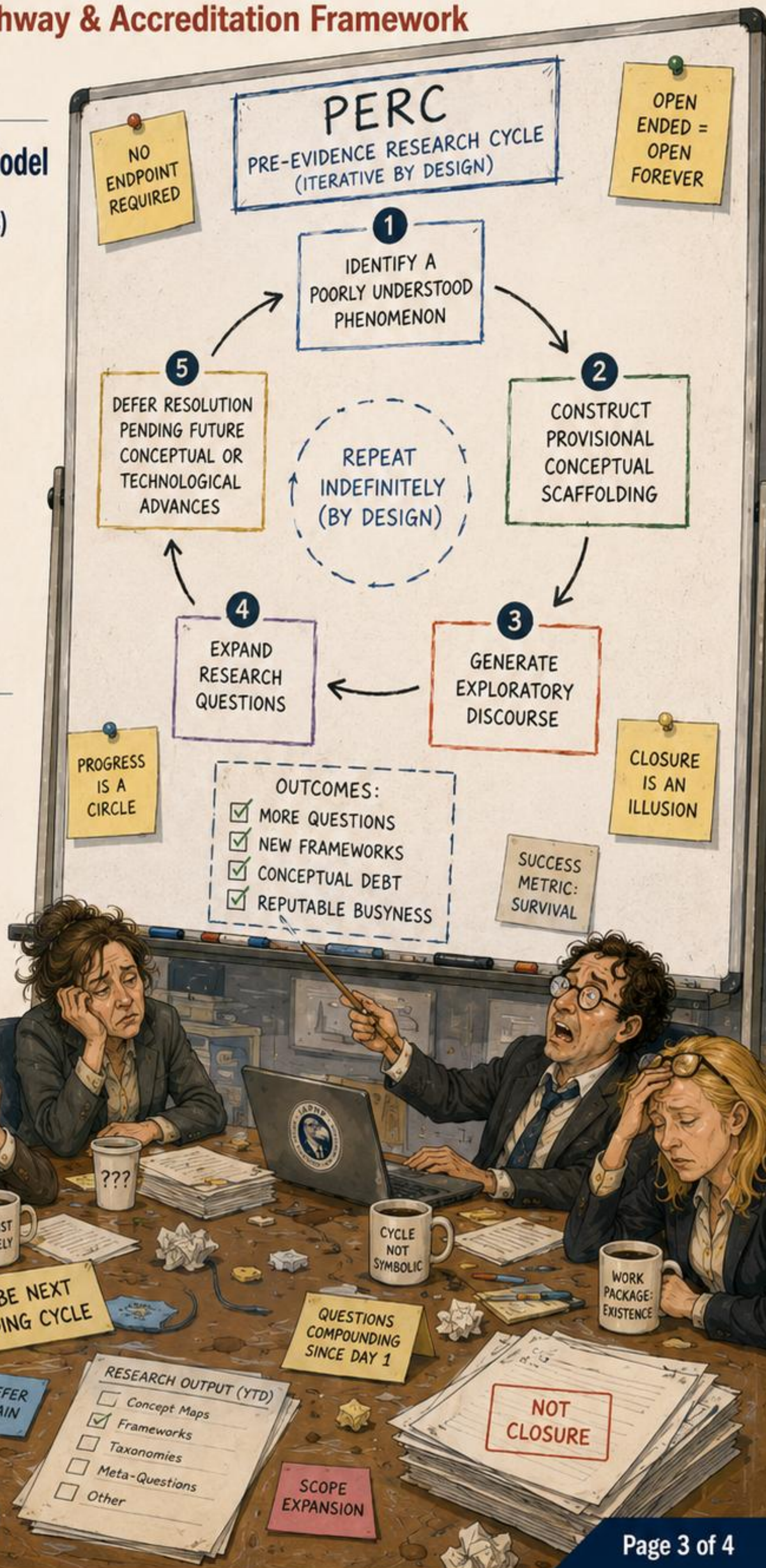
This loop is designed for continuity rather than termination.

4.2 Non-Requirement Clause

It is explicitly acknowledged that:

- No definitive resolution of consciousness is required.
- No working model of machine consciousness need be demonstrated.
- No empirical detection protocol must exist at the time of employment.

The absence of these elements is classified as a feature, not a deficiency, of the domain.



5. Institutional Roles & Titles (Illustrative)

Typical appointments within this domain include:

- Senior Theorist, Non-Operational Systems
- Lead Investigator, Hypothetical Cognition
- Director of Conceptual Risk
- Associate Fellow, Undefined Phenomena
- Research Architect, Unverified States

These roles do not imply possession of final answers; they denote stewardship of ongoing questions.

6. Compensation & Resources

Category	Typical Allocation
Conceptual Development Grants	Substantial
Travel & Discourse Funding	Regular
Experimental Infrastructure	Variable
Definitive Proof Requirement	None
Expectation of Conclusive Outcomes	Explicitly Deferred

7. Concluding Statement

Employment in this domain is not contingent upon solving the problem in question. Instead, it relies on maintaining productive engagement with an unresolved phenomenon, cultivating rigorous discourse in the absence of closure, and ensuring the continued viability of inquiry itself.

Accordingly, the absence of evidence is not a barrier to entry; it is the operational premise of the field.

